

Cultural Homophily in Grand Slam Doubles

ATP Men's Grand Slam Doubles, 2018–2025 · N = 1,793 matches after dropping 47 retirements / walkovers · Team-level panel: 3,586 obs (2 per match)

1. Data and Measures

Three culture measures capture teammate similarity. **Same nationality** and **same official language** are binary (0/1). **Language proximity** is a continuous 0–1 index of ethnolinguistic closeness (higher = more similar language family). All descriptive figures show the share of teams (pooled across winners and losers) that are *same* vs. *different* on each dimension.

Regressions use a team-level panel with tournament-by-year fixed effects, round fixed effects, and standard errors clustered by match. Controls: team average doubles ranking, opponent average ranking, teammate rank gap, top-100 singles indicator (either player). Culture measures enter one at a time.

2. Pressure Outcome Counts

Outcome	N	Share of matches
Set-1 tiebreak (7-pt)	445	24.8%
Set-2 tiebreak (7-pt)	470	26.2%
Any regular tiebreak (sets 1–2)	804	44.8%
Match tiebreak / super-tb (10-pt, set 3)	24	1.3%
Any tiebreak (all types)	896	50.0%
Match went to 3 sets	787	43.9%
Comeback wins (winner lost set 1)	351	19.6%

Match tiebreaks concentrated in Olympics (N=20) and Wimbledon post-2018 (N=4).

3. Olympic Cycle Descriptive Evidence

Table 2A — Tokyo 2021 cycle (Grand Slams only, Olympics excluded)

Period	GS window	N teams	Same Nat.	Diff Nat.	Same Lang.	Diff Lang.	Same Ling. Prox.	Diff Ling. Prox.
Pre-Tokyo	AO18 – USO19	1,006	39.6%	60.4%	53.0%	47.0%	53.9%	46.1%
Tokyo Prep	AO20 – Wim21 (ex Wim20)	364	41.2%	58.8%	54.1%	45.9%	54.1%	45.9%
Post-Tokyo	USO21 – USO22	604	37.6%	62.4%	52.2%	47.8%	53.0%	47.0%

N teams = matches × 2. Same/Diff = share of all teams (pooled winner + loser) on each cultural dimension.

Table 2B — Paris 2024 cycle (Grand Slams only, Olympics excluded)

Period	GS window	N teams	Same Nat.	Diff Nat.	Same Lang.	Diff Lang.	Same Ling. Prox.	Diff Ling. Prox.
Pre-Paris	AO22 – USO22	486	37.4%	62.6%	51.2%	48.8%	52.3%	47.7%
Paris Prep	AO23 – Wim24	860	41.0%	59.0%	55.6%	44.4%	56.0%	44.0%
Post-Paris	USO24 – USO25	626	43.1%	56.9%	54.8%	45.2%	56.2%	43.8%

N teams = matches × 2. Same/Diff = share of all teams (pooled winner + loser) on each cultural dimension.

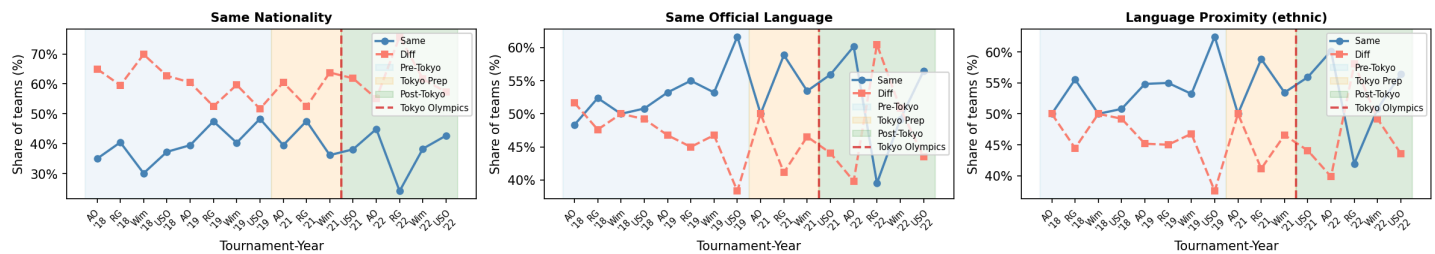
**Cultural Homophily in Grand Slam Doubles — Tokyo 2021 Cycle
(Same vs. Diff, by Tournament-Year)**

Figure 1. Share of teams that are same (solid) vs. different (dashed) on each cultural dimension, Grand Slams only. Shaded regions: Pre-Tokyo (blue), Tokyo Prep (orange), Post-Tokyo (green). Red dashed line marks the Tokyo Olympics (July–August 2021).

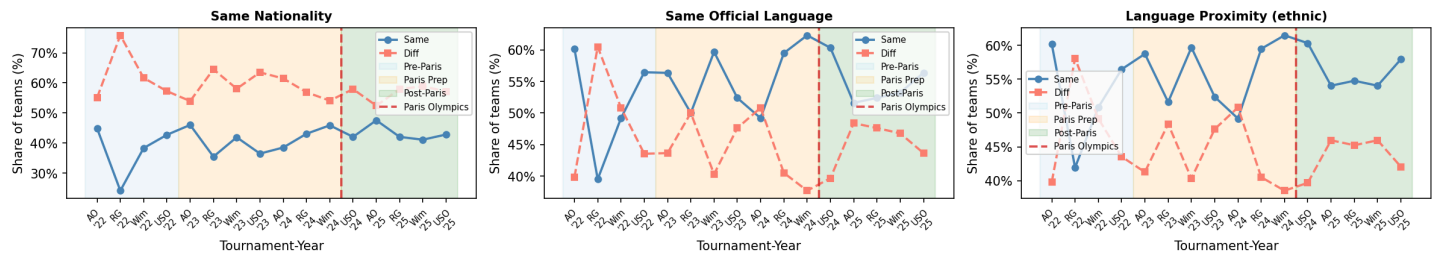
**Cultural Homophily in Grand Slam Doubles — Paris 2024 Cycle
(Same vs. Diff, by Tournament-Year)**

Figure 2. Share of teams that are same (solid) vs. different (dashed) on each cultural dimension, Grand Slams only. Shaded regions: Pre-Paris (blue), Paris Prep (orange), Post-Paris (green). Red dashed line marks the Paris Olympics (July–August 2024).

4. Regression Results

Logit coefficients (log-odds). Each column is a separate model. Standard errors in parentheses, clustered by match. Fixed effects: tournament × year and round (stage code). Sample: Grand Slams only.

Table 3 — Outcome: Match Win | N = 3,436 team-obs (1,718 matches)

Variable	(1) Same Nationality	(2) Same Language	(3) Lang. Proximity
Culture measure	+0.1093 (0.0764)	+0.1710 ^{**} (0.0733)	+0.1549 ^{**} (0.0732)
Team avg. doubles rank	−0.0041 ^{***} (0.0006)	−0.0041 ^{***} (0.0006)	−0.0040 ^{***} (0.0006)
Opponent avg. doubles rank	+0.0033 ^{***} (0.0003)	+0.0033 ^{***} (0.0003)	+0.0033 ^{***} (0.0003)
Teammate rank gap	+0.0008 (0.0005)	+0.0007 (0.0005)	+0.0007 (0.0005)
Top-100 singles player	+0.0180 (0.1460)	+0.0195 (0.1463)	+0.0215 (0.1462)
Pseudo-R ²	0.093	0.094	0.093

*** p<0.01 ** p<0.05 * p<0.10. Standard errors clustered by match. FE: tournament × year, round.

Table 4 — Outcome: Tiebreak Win | N = 1,717 team-obs (858 matches with any tiebreak)

Variable	(1) Same Nationality	(2) Same Language	(3) Lang. Proximity
Culture measure	+0.0278 (0.1130)	+0.0013 (0.1083)	−0.0263 (0.1081)
Team avg. doubles rank	−0.0008 (0.0005)	−0.0008 (0.0005)	−0.0008 (0.0005)
Opponent avg. doubles rank	+0.0010 ^{***} (0.0003)	+0.0010 ^{***} (0.0003)	+0.0010 ^{***} (0.0003)
Teammate rank gap	−0.0004 (0.0005)	−0.0004 (0.0005)	−0.0004 (0.0005)
Top-100 singles player	−0.3193 (0.2071)	−0.3173 (0.2070)	−0.3163 (0.2067)
Pseudo-R ²	0.025	0.025	0.025

*** p<0.01 ** p<0.05 * p<0.10. Standard errors clustered by match. FE: tournament × year, round. Sample restricted to matches where any tiebreak was played.

Table 5 — Outcome: Comeback Win | N = 762 team-obs (381 matches, winner lost set 1)

Variable	(1) Same Nationality	(2) Same Language	(3) Lang. Proximity
Culture measure	−0.3837 ^{**} (0.1762)	−0.4191 ^{**} (0.1717)	−0.3976 ^{**} (0.1709)
Team avg. doubles rank	−0.0020 ^{**} (0.0009)	−0.0021 ^{**} (0.0009)	−0.0021 ^{**} (0.0009)
Opponent avg. doubles rank	+0.0025 ^{***} (0.0007)	+0.0025 ^{***} (0.0007)	+0.0025 ^{***} (0.0007)
Teammate rank gap	+0.0002 (0.0008)	+0.0002 (0.0008)	+0.0002 (0.0008)
Top-100 singles player	+0.2009 (0.3384)	+0.1890 (0.3382)	+0.1890 (0.3380)
Pseudo-R ²	0.124	0.125	0.124

*** p<0.01 ** p<0.05 * p<0.10. Standard errors clustered by match. FE: tournament × year, round. Sample: 3-set matches where the eventual winner lost set 1. Tournament × year cells with no outcome variation dropped.